

Skink Care Quick-Start Sheet

Species-first setup rule

- Identify the exact species before buying equipment.
- Choose captive-bred animals where legal and available, then ask for feeding records, origin details and recent health history.
- Build the enclosure before the animal arrives and test heat, humidity, hides, water and substrate for several days.
- Do not use a single universal skink care number unless the source is truly about the exact species being kept.
- Treat temperature, humidity, substrate, lighting, diet and behavior as one husbandry system rather than isolated settings.
- Record observations in writing so changes in appetite, weight, shed quality and behavior are visible over time.

Daily and weekly checks

- Daily: check water, security, appetite, behavior, breathing and temperature readings.
- Two or three times weekly: check substrate moisture, shed progress, soiling and hide placement.
- Weekly: review food response, equipment stability, weight trend where safe to measure and any repeated abnormal signs.

Escalation boundary

- Contact a reptile veterinarian for breathing difficulty, burns, wounds, swelling, severe lethargy, rapid weight loss or appetite loss with decline.
- Do not start antibiotics, antiparasitic medicine, treatment-level supplements or strong topical products from a checklist alone.

Use with the full Skinkpedia article. Exact values change by species, age, locality, enclosure design and health status. This resource is educational and does not replace species-specific husbandry research or reptile-veterinary advice.